

Synopsys Santa Clara Valley Science and Engineering Championship
SRC Ethics Statement - from SSP/Regeneron ISEF Rules for All Projects

<https://www.societyforscience.org/isef/international-rules/rules-for-all-projects/#Ethics>

Ethics Statement

Student researchers, as well as adults who have a role in their projects, are expected to maintain the highest ethical standards. These include, but are not limited to:

- **Integrity.** Honesty, objectivity, and avoidance of conflicts of interest are expected during every phase of the research. The project should reflect independent research done by the student(s), and represent only one year's work.
- **Legality.** Compliance with all federal, country, state and local laws is essential. All projects must be approved by a Scientific Review Committee (SRC), and when necessary must also be approved by an Institutional Review Board (IRB), Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC), and/or Institutional Biosafety Committee (IBC).
- **Respect for Confidentiality and Intellectual Property.** Confidential communications, as well as patents, copyrights, and other forms of intellectual property must be honored. Unpublished data, methods, or results may not be used without permission, and credit must be given to all contributions to research.
- **Stewardship of the Environment.** It is the responsibility of the researcher(s) and the adults involved to protect the environment and its organisms from harm. All projects involve some amount of risk. Everyone is expected to recognize the hazards, assess the risks, minimize them, and prepare for emergencies.
- **Animal Care.** Proper care and respect must be given to vertebrate animals. The guiding principles for the use of animals in research includes the following "Four R's": Replace, Reduce, Refine, Respect.
- **Human Participant Protection.** The highest priority is the health and well-being of the student researcher(s) and human participants.
- **Potentially Hazardous Biological Agents (PHBAs).** It is the responsibility of the student and adults involved in the project to conduct and document a risk assessment, and to safely handle and dispose of organisms and materials.

Rule #2 from SCVSEFA Rules <https://science-fair.org/rules-and-registration/requirements/>

Scientific fraud and misconduct are not condoned at any level of research or competition. Such practices include plagiarism, forgery, use or presentation of other researcher's work as one's own, and fabrication of data. Fraudulent projects will fail to qualify for competition in affiliated fairs and ISEF. SCVSEFA and the Society for Science and the Public reserve the right to revoke recognition of a project subsequently found to have been fraudulent.

Students who have their projects removed from competition for fraud or misconduct may not enter the Synopsys Championship the following year.

I have read and I understand the SCVSEFA/ISEF Ethics Statement.

Print Student Name: Amaar Chughtai

Student Signature: Amaar Chughtai Digitally signed by Amaar Chughtai
Date: 2026.01.06 21:32:42 -08'00' Date: 01/06/26